Niccolò Zaccaria

Tilburg University

https://niccolozaccaria.com
n.zaccaria@tilburguniversity.edu
Office K332, Warandelaan 2, 5037AB Tilburg, NL.

October 26, 2026

Placement Officer: Prof. David Schindler d.schindler@tilburguniversity.edu

---

Education

2022–present	Ph.D. in Economics, Tilburg University
2020–2022	Research Master degree in Economics *with distinction*, Tilburg University
2017–2019	Master degree in Economics *summa cum laude*, Università di Firenze
2014–2017	Bachelor's degree in Economics, Università di Firenze

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, monetary economics, firm dynamics, aggregate effects of AI

Research Visits

2026	Department of Economics, New York University. Host: Dr. Corina Boar

Job Market Paper

Selection on Exit and Sticky Prices

This paper shows that the composition of entry and exit of products matters for the transmission of monetary shocks. Using retail scanner data, I show that low-revenue products exit more often and change prices less frequently. I develop a menu-cost model that matches the empirical evidence. In the model, price changes are costly, leading firms with higher exit risk to endogenously choose reset prices less frequently. This mechanism of selective product turnover is missing in standard models and amplifies the real effects of monetary policy: compared to a model with random turnover calibrated to the same moments, selective turnover raises the one-year cumulative output response to a monetary shock by 15%. Amplification reaches 35% near price stability and declines at higher inflation.

Publications

Labor Market Signals: The Role of Large Language Models (w/ K. Abbas Nejad, G. Musillo, and T. Wicker)
Forthcoming, ***Journal of Labor Economics***. DOI: 10.1086/744669

Large Language Models (LLMs) are transforming the labor market, including hiring decisions. This paper examines their impact on the signals job-seekers send to potential employers through two field experiments focusing on cover letters. We find that LLMs enhance signal quality, especially benefiting lower-quality applicants, yet these gains do not boost interview invitations because they are concentrated in standardized, less influential sections of the cover letter. LLMs furthermore reduce the frequency of grammatical errors, but reduce the text's readability by using longer words. When recruiters learn of LLM usage, they place greater value on high-quality, human-crafted letters. Hence, LLMs reduce the informativeness of signals, potentially increasing inefficiencies in labor market matching. A calibrated structural model estimates the losses compared to a setting without LLMs.

Working Papers

Corrective biases in coordination economies with dispersed information.

Can mistaken beliefs correct inefficient use of information? I study coordination economies with dispersed information in which private and social coordination incentives differ. When complete-information decisions are efficient, a common misperception of idiosyncratic precision can implement the constrained-efficient allocation. Overestimation provides the correction when private coordination incentives are too strong; underestimation when incentives are too weak. The optimal error depends on the payoffs but is invariant to the information structure. Correcting beliefs without correcting incentives can therefore lower welfare. In a two-period extension where actions generate information, efficiency requires different precision corrections across times. A constant error can still improve welfare but cannot implement the linear team optimum.

Mispricing Through Misconfidence. (w/ S. Suetens and B. Uras)

This paper investigates the impact of misconfidence on price stickiness in markets characterized by strategic complementarities. Misconfidence denotes the tendency of cognitively able individuals to underestimate the cognitive ability of others. In an experiment, we first measure cognitive ability and misconfidence, and then have participants make price choices in a market. We find that prices in markets with at least one misconfident participant deviate significantly more from equilibrium levels than in markets composed exclusively of confident, cognitively able agents. Importantly, misconfident individuals are no more prone to self-assessment errors than others, indicating that misconfidence is a belief distortion about others that is not reducible to over- or underconfidence about the self.

Efficient two-sample instrumental variable estimators with change points and near-weak identification (w/ B. Antoine and O. Boldea)

We consider estimation and inference in a linear model with endogenous regressors where the parameters of interest change across two samples. If the first-stage is common, we show how to use this information to obtain more efficient two-sample GMM estimators than the standard split-sample GMM, even in the presence of near-weak instruments. We also propose two tests to detect change points in the parameters of interest, depending on whether the first-stage is common or not. We derive the limiting distribution of these tests and show that they have non-trivial power even under weaker and possibly time-varying identification patterns. The finite sample properties of our proposed estimators and testing procedures are illustrated in a series of Monte-Carlo experiments, and in an application to the open-economy New Keynesian Phillips curve. Our empirical analysis using US data provides strong support for a New Keynesian Phillips curve with incomplete pass-through and reveals important time variation in the relationship between inflation and exchange rate pass-through.

Work in progress

Markups and Price Discovery (w/ E. Casanovas)

There is a large and ongoing debate over the rise in market concentration and the aggregate markup. This whole discussion assumes that firms know their demand perfectly and take it as given. What if firms have to learn their demand instead? Using scanner data, we show that firms learn their demand elasticity by moving prices and watching how sales respond; repricing looks like search. Products settle at a stable level, and move in the direction of a product's long-run settled level. We then show that this search raises the aggregate markup. When firms are uncertain about demand, their prices are scattered around the optimum. Mispriced products lose sales, with larger losses for the products with the highest markups, so this scatter pulls the aggregate markup down. As firms learn, sales shift toward high-markup products, and the aggregate markup rises toward its full-information level. Better pricing tools, such as larger datasets and market research, speed up this search and can therefore help explain part of the rise in markups over time.

AI at the Gate: Platform Answers and the Supply of News (w/ G. Musillo and T. Wicker)

How does generative AI affect competition and production in markets for information? We study this question through Google's AI Overviews, which provides AI generated answers above search results. We combine weekly internet traffic data of major US and UK news outlet with the launch of AI Overviews to build a novel outlet-level measure of exposure to AI, the share of an outlet's articles containing no original reporting, and provide a causal estimate of generative AI on the market for information. We show that a one-standard-deviation increase in replaceability is associated with a 10.8% larger decline in visits after launch and an 8.7% decline in monthly unique visitors. We develop a general-equilibrium model in which AI platforms use news outlets' content to generate answers while competing with them for readers. We show that compensating outlets for lost traffic would mostly benefit producers of replaceable content, whose decline is largely efficient: generated answers supply the same information at a lower cost in readers' time. Instead, payments for the use of original reporting sustain the production of information that AI cannot reproduce, while preserving the time savings from AI-generated answers.

Economics of Prompting AI: An Application to Financial Portfolio Management (w/ H. van Buggenum and B. Uras)

Is it always optimal to communicate truthfully with AI? We study portfolio delegation to an AI advisor that can account for higher moments of the return distribution. The investor chooses whether to report the truthful degree of risk aversion to the AI or not, and how many moments to compute. We show that truthful reporting is optimal only when the advisor accounts for the full distribution. Otherwise, the investor should inflate her reported risk aversion when the omitted moments are unfavorable, as with negative skewness or fat tails, and deflate it when they are favorable. With leverage constraints, investors with intermediate risk aversion gain the most from delegation: leverage limits prevent the most risk-tolerant from acting on better information, while the most risk-averse hold positions too small for it to matter.

Bootstrap Methods for Impulse Responses Obtained by Local Projections (w/ O. Boldea, A. Cornea-Madeira, and A. Hall).

Other writings

AI maakt solliciteren makkelijker, maar matching moeilijker. **ESB** (2026), Vol. 111(4859): 330-332.

Teaching Experience

2024–present	TA *Macroeconomics 1*, graduate level, Tilburg University
2023–present	TA *Macroeconomics for Econometrics and Operation Research*, undergraduate level, Tilburg University
2022–2024	TA *Macroeconomics 2*, graduate level, Tilburg University
2022–present	Undergraduate thesis supervision, undergraduate level, Tilburg University

Seminar & Conference Presentations

2026	NYU macro student lunch, Tilburg internal workshop, UCL ENTER seminar, UC3M ENTER jamboree, EUI PhD workshop, EEA-ESEM Dublin
2025	Brownbag Seminar of Behavioral Sciences Maastricht, ENTER Jamboree Stockholm School of Economics, BSF Theoretical and Experimental Macroeconomics, Behavioral Macroeconomics Workshop Bamberg
2024	ENTER Jamboree ULB, Tilburg, JADS Doctoral symposium 's-Hertogenbosch
2023	ENTER Jamboree Mannheim, BSF Theoretical and Experimental Macroeconomics, ESA World Lyon
2022	ESA Europe Bologna

*scheduled

Grants, Scholarships, and Awards

2024	OpenAI Researcher Access Program
2022	CentER scholarship for Research Master in Economics.
2021	"Ready, study, go!" scholarship, Fondazione CARIPT.

Refereeing

European Economic Review

Professional service

2022–2025	Macro Study Group organizer, Tilburg University
2022–2026	Graduate Students' Society chairman, Tilburg University
2022–2025	ENTER coordinator, Tilburg University

Computer Skills

Matlab, Python, R, Stata.

Languages

Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

References

Dr. Burak Uras
Department of Economics
Williams College
+1 (413) 597-2709
bu1@williams.edu

Prof. Sigrid Suetens
Department of Economics
Tilburg University
+31 13 466 8790
s.suetens@tilburguniversity.edu

Dr. Has van Vlokhoven
Department of Economics
Tilburg University
+31 13 466 3219
h.vanvlokhoven@tilburguniversity.edu